

SYED AYAD ALI

Project Manager | Product Manager | Customer Success Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Project Manager and Customer Success Leader with 9+ years of experience delivering complex, enterprise-scale projects for Fortune 500 companies and US Government clients. Proven ability to manage multi-stakeholder programmes, drive client retention, and lead cross-functional teams. Combines strategic thinking with hands-on execution — from WCAG compliance initiatives that unlocked 10% of company revenue to AI-powered tools that reduced reporting time by 96%. Adept at turning ambiguity into clarity and building long-term client relationships that drive renewal and growth.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Maintained 87% logo retention and 90% booking retention across the US East region in 2025.
- Reduced post-event reporting time from 2 weeks to 30 minutes by building an AI-powered analytics dashboard using Claude AI.
- Led WCAG 2.1 / ADA compliance initiative that contributed to 10% of total company revenue and enabled partnerships with Microsoft, Lilly, and Nationwide.
- Managed 35+ projects in 2021 with a combined contract value of USD 1.2M, achieving a ~60% client renewal rate.
- Created a new enterprise revenue stream by establishing a dedicated Webinar Management System, reducing churn in the enterprise segment.
- Grew Riyadh regional sales by SAR 1.5M through strategic contract negotiations with ARASCO.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Regional Project Head – US East | vFairs

Feb 2024 – Present

- Oversee all project implementation across the US East region, serving as the senior point of accountability for delivery quality.
- Manage the top 10% of US East clients, ensuring their needs are met to the highest standard and acting as strategic advisor.
- Lead training and professional development programmes for project managers and coordinators.
- Drive renewal and retention strategy by equipping clients and project managers with tools to elevate the customer experience.
- Maintained 85% logo retention and 87% booking retention in 2025 through proactive relationship management.
- Foster a collaborative, knowledge-sharing culture across the regional team.

Senior Project Manager & Team Lead | vFairs

Feb 2023 – Feb 2024

- Led end-to-end event planning and execution for enterprise clients from discovery through post-event reporting.
- Collaborated with clients to define event objectives, KPIs, and target audience strategies.
- Sourced, negotiated with, and managed external vendors and service providers.
- Provided technical guidance on platform setup, configuration, and troubleshooting.

Senior Project Manager | vFairs

Feb 2022 – Jan 2023

- Supervised event operations, ensuring all technical and logistical aspects ran smoothly throughout delivery.

- Partnered with cross-functional teams — product, design, and engineering — to align projects with organisational goals.
- Identified and implemented process improvements and automation initiatives to drive operational efficiency.
- Proactively identified risks and escalated issues to prevent project delivery failures.

Project Manager Level 2 | vFairs

Aug 2020 – Feb 2022

- Managed 35+ projects in 2021 across the US and Canada with a combined contract value of USD 1.2M.
- Led implementation of WCAG 2.1 accessibility standards, opening access to a new compliance-critical market segment.
- Achieved a client renewal rate of approximately 60% through strong relationship management.
- Managed a team of two Project Managers and two Project Coordinators.
- Delivered projects for Fortune 500 and US Government clients including Lilly, General Motors, Amazon, DARPA, and CMS.

Sales Executive | Basic Chemical Industries

Dec 2016 – Jun 2018

- Achieved annual sales of SAR 4.5M in FY2017 through strategic account development and retention.
- Grew Riyadh regional sales by SAR 1.5M by negotiating and securing a contract with ARASCO.
- Managed a portfolio of ~25 key accounts including ARASCO, PepsiCo, and Coca-Cola.
- Reduced accounts receivable by 80% through improved credit management and client engagement.

Trainee Process Engineer | Lotte Chemical Pakistan Limited

Jul 2014 – Nov 2015

- Redesigned soda ash addition process control, achieving a 33% reduction in waste by-product.
- Evaluated and optimised gas-type shell-and-tube heat exchanger design.
- Coordinated Total Productive Maintenance (TPM) activities and ongoing plant housekeeping.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA) | Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS)

Jun 2018 – Jun 2020

Bachelor of Engineering – Chemical Engineering | University of Engineering and Technology (UET)

Sep 2010 – Jul 2014

CORE COMPETENCIES

• Project & Programme Management	• Customer Success & Retention	• Stakeholder Management
• Product Strategy & Roadmapping	• Cross-Functional Team Leadership	• Process Improvement & Automation
• Enterprise Account Management	• WCAG 2.1 / ADA Compliance	• AI & Automation (Claude AI, Zapier)

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

Jira | ClickUp | Confluence | Notion | Slack | Zoom | Salesforce | HubSpot | Google Analytics | Figma | Zapier | Claude AI | ChatGPT | Microsoft Project | WCAG / NVDA Accessibility Tools

NOTABLE CLIENTS & PARTNERS

Amazon | General Motors | Microsoft | Lilly (Eli Lilly) | Nationwide | DARPA | Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) | Hospital for Special Surgery | University of Maryland Global Campus | Girls Who Code | University of Massachusetts